

# *The Legend of Sleepy Hollow*

Washington Irving · 1820

First published: The Sketch Book, 1820

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

**Cambridge International edition** (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Sketchbook_of_Geoffrey_Crayon_(1819)/The_Legend_of_Sleepy_Hollow (revision 15829956), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

**Grades:** Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about superstition and imagination?
- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about greed and courtship?
- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about rural community?

## Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

## Standards: Cambridge International

CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5

Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)

**Assessments:** Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Introduction: author, context and reception*<br>The Legend of Sleepy Hollow | 2 × 90 min (180 min) | *superstition and imagination*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Story quizzes in the app<br>• Introduction: author, context and reception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Introduction to The Legend of Sleepy Hollow

**Objective:** Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Washington Irving's life or times connects to superstition and imagination in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (superstition and imagination, greed and courtship, rural community).

**Standards:** Cambridge International: see the unit standards

### *Author biography*

Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859.

### *Historical and cultural context*

Set around 1790 in a Dutch settlement near Tarrytown, New York, a region full of Revolutionary War ghost stories. The Headless Horseman is said to be a Hessian soldier (a German mercenary fighting for Britain) whose head was shot off by a cannonball.

### *Publication and reception, then and now*

Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (part VI, 1820).

**Then:** Popular from the start.

**Now:** One of the first American ghost stories; a Halloween classic, often adapted.

### *Overview (spoiler-free)*

Ichabod Crane, a lanky, superstitious schoolmaster from Connecticut, courts the wealthy Katrina Van Tassel, competing with the local hero Brom Bones.

### *Main themes*

- imagination and superstition.
- greed.
- outsiders and locals.

### *Why it matters*

It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.

Spoilers · teacher only

Riding home from a party, Ichabod is chased by the Headless Horseman, who hurls his head; Ichabod disappears, a smashed pumpkin is found, and Brom marries Katrina, looking knowing whenever the pumpkin is mentioned.

*Lesson plan (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Before we open The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: What local legend do you know? Why do people tell it?*
**Prompt:** Before we open The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: What local legend do you know? Why do people tell it?

**8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**
Key literary terms for the unit.
*legend; satire; characterization; ambiguity.*

**18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
*About the author. Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859. The world of the book. Set around 1790 in a Dutch settlement near Tarrytown, New York, a region full of Revolutionary War ghost stories. The Headless Horseman is said to be a Hessian soldier (a German mercenary fighting for Britain) whose head was shot off by a cannonball. Publication and reception. Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (part VI, 1820). Then: Popular from the start. Now: One of the first American ghost stories; a Halloween classic, often adapted.*

**28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)**
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The legend is called the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the capitals, which turn the description into a proper name. The strongest word is "Horseman": it pictures a rider, so the ghost can chase. Then, effect. Why does Irving give the ghost such a memorable title? My answer: Irving creates a folk legend with a catchy name; the story is about how such legends grow and get used.*

> *The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The legend is called the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the capitals, which turn the description into a proper name. The strongest word is "Horseman": it pictures a rider, so the ghost can chase. Then, effect. Why does Irving give the ghost such a memorable title? My answer: Irving creates a folk legend with a catchy name; the story is about how such legends grow and get used.

**40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)**
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
*What the book is about (no spoilers): Ichabod Crane, a lanky, superstitious schoolmaster from Connecticut, courts the wealthy Katrina Van Tassel, competing with the local hero Brom Bones. Themes to track: imagination and superstition.: greed.: outsiders and locals.:*

**55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)**
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
*Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: superstition and imagination. Prediction: Ichabod Crane, a superstitious schoolmaster courting Katrina Van Tassel, will be tested by the local legend of the Headless Horseman. Question: is the ghost real, or is someone using the legend?*
**Task:** Set up a reading journal for The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
**Exemplar:** Page: superstition and imagination. Prediction: Ichabod Crane, a superstitious schoolmaster courting Katrina Van Tassel, will be tested by the local legend of the Headless Horseman. Question: is the ghost real, or is someone using the legend?

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
*Why does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow still matter? It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.*
**Anchor question:** Why might The Legend of Sleepy Hollow still be taught today?
**Facilitation:** It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)**
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
*Irving grew up in New York and wrote this in 1820 as one of the first American writers famous in Europe. Why did he want to create American legends? Answer: Accept answers such as: the young nation lacked its own folklore; he drew on Hudson Valley Dutch tales; he wanted American places to feel storied.*
**Exit ticket:** Irving grew up in New York and wrote this in 1820 as one of the first American writers famous in Europe. Why did he want to create American legends?
**Answer:** Accept answers such as: the young nation lacked its own folklore; he drew on Hudson Valley Dutch tales; he wanted American places to feel storied.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Preview the first reading.
*Tomorrow we begin reading: The Legend of Sleepy Hollow.*

**Teacher notes · sources:** Historic Hudson Valley, "Washington Irving" (https://hudsonvalley.org/); Britannica, "Washington Irving" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Washington-Irving); Washington Irving, The Sketch Book (1819–20) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/2048); Historic Hudson Valley, Washington Irving's Sunnyside (https://hudsonvalley.org/historic-sites/sunnyside/)

## Lesson 2: The Legend of Sleepy Hollow

**Focus:** superstition used against a credulous man

**Objective:** Students will analyze how setting develops in "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

**Standards:** Cambridge International: see the unit standards

**Content note (mild fright, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)):** Sensitive content: Mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language). Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…e spirits rose with eating, as some men's do with drink. He could not help, too, rolling his la…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
**Student preview:** Heads-up: this story includes mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language).
**Suggested language:** "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless Horseman who hurls his head at him. Ichabod disappears; a shattered pumpkin is found. Brom marries Katrina and looks knowing when the tale is told.

**Background:** Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York.

**Significance:** A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why do people enjoy being scared by stories? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to greed because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language).*
**Prompt:** Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to greed because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: tractable — easy to manage or control; preferment — promotion to a better position, especially in the church; imbibed — take in, also metaphorically; uselessly — without purpose; thwarted — hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of. "tractable": Origin: Latin tractābilis ("that may be touched"). "thwarted": Origin of "thwart": Old Norse þvert.*
**Words:** tractable: easy to manage or control · preferment: promotion to a better position, especially in the church · imbibed: take in, also metaphorically · uselessly: without purpose · thwarted: hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York. A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony. Satire: Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite. Imagery: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast. Ambiguity: The ending hints at Brom. Watch for the pumpkin: the joke at the heart of the ghost.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator names the valley's chief ghost: the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "H" sounds, which make the name easy to repeat like a local legend. The strongest word is "Headless": the missing head is the frightening detail people remember. Then, effect. How does the name of the ghost work on the reader and the townspeople? My answer: The name already makes the ghost a legend that everyone in the valley tells; that shared story is what Brom later uses to frighten Ichabod away.*

> *The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10)*

**Think-aloud:** First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator names the valley's chief ghost: the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "H" sounds, which make the name easy to repeat like a local legend. The strongest word is "Headless": the missing head is the frightening detail people remember. Then, effect. How does the name of the ghost work on the reader and the townspeople? My answer: The name already makes the ghost a legend that everyone in the valley tells; that shared story is what Brom later uses to frighten Ichabod away.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Greed. Look at the craft: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast. Ask: How does this line connect to greed? Expected: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. (Greed.)*

> *the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Greed. Look at the craft: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to greed?
**Expected answer:** Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. (Greed.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the story for satire, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. When the text says “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins … turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.*
**Task:** Annotate the story for satire, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. When the text says “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins … turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why do people enjoy being scared by stories? Ask: is Ichabod a victim or deserving?*
**Anchor question:** Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
**Facilitation:** Ask: is Ichabod a victim or deserving?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. ("he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones", The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. ("he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones", The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how satire shapes superstition used against a credulous man. Key takeaway: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Satire:** Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite.
- **Imagery:** Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.
- **Ambiguity:** The ending hints at Brom.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **greed:** Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the pumpkin:** the joke at the heart of the ghost.

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) The legend.
- "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) Greed.
- "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) The rival.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom.
**Evidence:** "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31)

**Reasoning:** Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **tractable** (adjective) | easy to manage or control | *He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.* | "tractable": Origin: Latin tractābilis ("that may be touched"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tractable#Etymology) |
| **preferment** (noun) | promotion to a better position, especially in the church | *"Ergo, for a country schoolmaster to be refused the hand of a Dutch heiress, is a certain step to high preferment in the state."* | |
| **imbibed** (verb) | take in, also metaphorically | *It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.* | |
| **uselessly** (adverb) | without purpose | *A sloop was loitering in the distance, dropping slowly down with the tide, her sail hanging uselessly against the mast; and as the reflection of the sky gleamed along the still water, it seemed as if the vessel was suspended in the air.* | |
| **thwarted** (verb) | hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of | *To have taken the field openly against his rival, would have been madness; for he was not man to be thwarted in his amours, any more than that stormy lover, Achilles.* | "thwarted": Origin of "thwart": Old Norse þvert. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/thwart#Etymology) |
| **chestnuts** (noun) | chestnut trees | *On that side of the road where the brook entered the wood, a group of oaks and chestnuts, matted thick with wild grape vines, threw a cavernous gloom over it.* | |
| **insinuating** (adjective) | winning favor in a sly, flattering way | *Ichabod, therefore, made his advances in a quiet and gently-insinuating manner.* | |
| **despaired** (verb) | abandon hope; give up hope; lose heart | *Such was the formidable rival with whom Ichabod Crane had to contend, and, considering all things, a stouter man than he would have shrunk from the* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *competition, and a wiser man would have despaired.* | |
| **extracts** (noun) | passages copied out of a book | *He repaid them in kind with large extracts from his invaluable author, Cotton Mather, and added many marvellous events that had taken place in his native state of Connecticut, and fearful sights which he had seen in his nightly walks about Sleepy Hollow.* | |
| **resides** (verb) | make one's home in a particular place or community | *It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.* | "resides": Origin of "reside": Old French resider; earlier Latin resideō ("remain behind"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reside#Etymology) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
2. Where does setting appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with superstition and imagination?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What is Ichabod Crane's job? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Schoolmaster
2. Why does Ichabod want to marry Katrina? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Partly for her father's wealth
3. Who is Ichabod's rival? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Brom Bones
4. What is found the next morning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin
5. Who is hinted to be the Headless Horseman? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Brom Bones
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless Horseman who hurls his head at him. Ichabod disappears; a shattered pumpkin is found. Brom marries…

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.” What does “tractable” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: tractable: easy to manage or control.
10. Reread: “"Ergo, for a country schoolmaster to be refused the hand of a Dutch heiress, is a certain step to high preferment in the state."” What does “preferment” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: preferment: promotion to a better position, especially in the church.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. What does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.
2. Find one example of setting in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the characterization in this story shape what we understand about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Such is the general purport of this legendary superstition, which has furnished materials for many a wild story in that region of shadows; and the spectre is known at all the…”, why might Irving have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” set up that the rest of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than

Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with superstition and imagination? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. A critic might argue: “A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to greed and courtship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Irving need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the setting in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" treats superstition used against a credulous man with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve superstition and imagination? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10):

The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Washington Irving about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

### *Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 49? “Old Baltus Van Tassel moved about among his guests with a face _____ with content and good humor, round and jolly as the harvest moon.”

   A. dilated

   B. Greensburgh

   C. apparition

   D. bustle

   Key: A (dilated)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10: “The _____ Horseman of Sleepy Hollow”
   Key: Headless
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43: “the yellow _____ lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun”
   Key: pumpkins
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31: “he had _____ the nick-name of Brom Bones”
   Key: received

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.3] What is Ichabod Crane's job?

   A. Farmer

   B. Minister

   C. Blacksmith

   D. Schoolmaster

   Key: D (Schoolmaster)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.3] What is found the next morning?

   A. Ichabod's body

   B. A sword

   C. Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin

   D. A horse's head

   Key: C (Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.3] Why does Ichabod want to marry Katrina?

   A. For her singing

   B. Partly for her father's wealth

   C. Because Brom tells him to

   D. To leave town

   Key: B (Partly for her father's wealth)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On that side of the road where the brook entered the wood, a group of oaks and _____, matted thick with wild grape vines, threw a cavernous gloom over it." Word bank: imbibed, preferment, chestnuts, tractable

   Key: chestnuts

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Ichabod, therefore, made his advances in a quiet and gently-_____ manner." Word bank: preferment, imbibed, tractable, insinuating

   Key: insinuating

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 6: "Nicholas when they crossed, there lies a small market town or rural port, which by some is called _____, but which is more generally and properly known by the name of Tarry Town." Word bank: discontented, apparition, shrewdness, Greensburgh

    Key: Greensburgh

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 6 reveal about the character or situation? "Not far from this village, perhaps about two miles, there is a little valley, or rather lap of land, among high hills, which is one of the quietest places in the whole world." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 6) accurately and quotes "quietest" and "village", saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Greed. The words "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 50 reveal about the character or situation? “The musician was an old grey-headed negro, who had been the itinerant orchestra of the neighbourhood for more than half a century.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 50) accurately and quotes “neighbourhood” and “orchestra”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.3] Claim: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31).
    Sample answer: Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned. The words “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “She was a blooming lass of fresh eighteen; plump as a partridge; ripe and melting and rosy cheeked as one of her father's peaches, and universally famed, not merely for her beauty, but her vast expectations.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 25) accurately and quotes “expectations” and “universally”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · L.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The legend. The words “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 13? “His head was small, and flat at top, with huge ears, large green glassy eyes, and a long snipe nose, so that it looked like a _____, perched upon his spindle neck, to tell which way the wind blew.”

    A. completely
    B. bustle
    C. shrewdness
    D. weathercock

    Key: D (weathercock)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “To have taken the field openly against his rival, would have been madness; for he was not man to be _____ in his amours, any more than that stormy lover, Achilles.” Word bank: thwarted, imbibed, preferment, tractable
    Key: thwarted

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 40: “Such was the _____ of Ichabod and his steed, as they shambled out of the gate of Hans Van Ripper, and it was altogether such an apparition as is seldom to be met with in broad day light.” Word bank: weathercock, shrewdness, Greensburgh, appearance
    Key: appearance

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 14 shapes its tone: “The school-house stood in a rather lonely but pleasant situation, just at the foot of a woody hill, with a brook running close by, and a formidable birch tree growing at one end of it.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 14) accurately and quotes “formidable” and “situation”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 62 shapes its tone: “The night grew darker and darker; the stars seemed to sink deeper in the sky, and driving clouds occasionally had them from his sight.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 62) accurately and quotes “occasionally” and “driving”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Synthesis: trace how greed develops from the opening of “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 21: “He was, in fact, an odd mixture of small _____ and simple credulity.” Word bank: shrewdness, reverberated, appearance, undisputed
    Key: shrewdness

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.3] Who is hinted to be the Headless Horseman?

    A. The narrator
    B. Katrina
    C. Ichabod himself
    D. Brom Bones

    Key: D (Brom Bones)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.3] Who is Ichabod's rival?

    A. The Horseman
    B. Hans Van Ripper
    C. Brom Bones
    D. Baltus Van Tassel

    Key: C (Brom Bones)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Connect this passage from paragraph 70 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “Just then he saw the goblin rising in his stirrups, and in the very act of hurling his head at him.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 70) accurately and quotes “stirrups” and “hurling”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to superstition and imagination and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Connect this passage from paragraph 66 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “Just then the shadowy object of alarm put itself in motion, and with a scramble and a bound, stood at once in the middle of the road.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 66) accurately and quotes “scramble” and “shadowy”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to superstition and imagination and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Such was the formidable rival with whom Ichabod Crane had to contend, and, considering all things, a stouter man than he would have shrunk from the competition, and a wiser man would have _____.” Word bank: imbibed, preferment, tractable, despaired
    Key: despaired

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The rival. The words “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 29? “Benches were built along the sides for summer use; and a great spinning wheel at one end, and a churn at the other, showed the various uses to which this _____ porch might be devoted.”
    A. appearance
    B. important
    C. discontented
    D. dilated
    Key: B (important)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 56 shapes its tone: “The chief part of the stories, however, turned upon the favorite spectre of Sleepy Hollow, the headless horseman, who had been heard several times of late, patroling the country; and, it was said, tethered his horse nightly among the…” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 56) accurately and quotes “patroling” and “headless”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Connect this passage from paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “From the moment Ichabod laid his eyes upon these regions of delight, the

peace of his mind was at an end, and his only study was how to gain the affections of the peerless daughter of Van Tassel." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 30) accurately and quotes "affections" and "daughter", saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to superstition and imagination and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Connect this passage from paragraph 41 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: "Streaming files of wild ducks began to make their appearance high in the air; the bark of the squirrel might be heard from the groves of beech and hickory nuts, and the pensive whistle of the quail at intervals from the neighbouring…" Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 41) accurately and quotes "neighbouring" and "appearance", saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to superstition and imagination and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.3] Evaluate this claim about the story: "Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive only in part. In support, "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) bears it out: Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned. But "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) complicates it, because this detail (the legend) gives the reader a second explanation to weigh against the claim's reading. So the claim holds only once it is qualified: it explains much of the story, but it has to account for that passage too, which it does not do on its own.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · L.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Greed. The words "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] In the line "He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.", what does "tractable" most nearly mean?

A. without purpose

B. easy to manage or control

C. take in, also metaphorically

D. promotion to a better position, especially in the church

Key: B (easy to manage or control)

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow"? Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite.

A. Characterization

B. Personification

C. Satire

D. Metaphor

Key: C (Satire)

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · L.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”? Abundant food this device shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.

A. Theme

B. Structure

C. Imagery

D. Point of view

Key: C (Imagery)

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 | recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 7, 3, 5, 17, 10, 18, 2, 9, 1, 19, 13, 11, 20, 14, 21, 22 | recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 18, 17, 23, 24, 25, 7, 10, 3, 11, 13, 12, 14, 15, 21, 26, 27 | recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 5, 7, 10, 28, 18, 24, 8, 6, 13, 11, 29, 21, 15, 20, 26, 16 | recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 30, 5, 25, 28, 8, 7, 11, 12, 13, 20, 31, 15, 21, 26, 32, 33 | recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 19, 24, 3, 5, 7, 25, 31, 15, 20, 21, 14, 32, 34, 35, 33, 26 | recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5 |
| College Freshman | 36, 3, 23, 5, 7, 25, 20, 21, 14, 31, 16, 26, 32, 22, 35, 34 | recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6 |
| College Sophomore | 4, 7, 18, 5, 25, 37, 21, 15, 14, 32, 26, 33, 16, 27, 34, 35 | recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7 |
| College Junior | 30, 7, 18, 8, 5, 20, 31, 21, 15, 37, 34, 33, 26, 16, 27, 32 | recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6 |
| College Senior | 6, 18, 8, 5, 7, 25, 29, 15, 31, 35, 27, 34, 33, 22, 32, 26 | recall 6, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 7 |
| Graduate / PhD | 8, 18, 5, 7, 25, 11, 38, 31, 15, 20, 32, 27, 34, 33, 16, 26 | recall 5, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 6 |

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Scaffolded support** (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow,” how does Irving show superstition used against a credulous man? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, how does Irving develop the idea of superstition used against a credulous man? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the story helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of superstition used against a credulous man. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggests about superstition used against a credulous man. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Washington Irving uses setting in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow to complicate the reader's understanding of superstition used against a credulous man. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate The Legend of Sleepy Hollow within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of superstition used against a credulous man responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read The Legend of Sleepy Hollow alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of superstition used against a credulous man follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Legend of Sleepy Hollow and its treatment of superstition used against a credulous man. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Legend of Sleepy Hollow as evidence for a larger claim about superstition used against a credulous man in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Legend of Sleepy Hollow as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of superstition used against a credulous man. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Legend of Sleepy Hollow.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.*

As used in the text, what does the word "imbibed" most nearly mean?

A. make one's home in a particular place or community

B. passages copied out of a book

C. take in, also metaphorically

D. abandon hope; give up hope; lose heart

2. *Such is the general purport of this legendary superstition, which has furnished materials for many a wild story in that region of shadows; and the spectre is known at all the country firesides by the name of The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow"?

A. The futile attempt to shut out death

B. Superstition used against a credulous man

C. Enemies reconciled too late

D. The loss of faith in human goodness

**SAT key:** 1. C (take in, also metaphorically); 2. B (Superstition used against a credulous man)

# Unit test

**The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: end test** · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

## Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

### *Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)*

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 18? “It was a matter of no little vanity to him on Sundays, to take his station in front of the church gallery, with a band of chosen singers; where, in his own mind, he _____ carried away the palm from the parson.”

   A. especially

   B. completely

   C. dilated

   D. important

   Key: B (completely)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 7? “I had wandered into it at noon time, when all nature is peculiarly quiet, and was startled by the roar of my own gun, as it broke the sabbath stillness around, and was prolonged and _____ by the angry echoes.”

   A. reverberated

   B. behooved

   C. apparition

   D. completely

   Key: A (reverberated)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 26: “A stately squadron of snowy geese were riding in an adjoining pond, convoying whole fleets of ducks; regiments of turkeys were gobbling through the farm yard, and guinea fowls fretting about it, like ill-tempered housewives, with their peevish _____ cry.” Word bank: shrewdness, important, discontented, apparition

   Key: discontented

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 47: “There was the doughty dough-nut, the tenderer oly koek, and the crisp and _____ cruller; sweet cakes and short cakes, ginger cakes and honey cakes, and the whole family of cakes.” Word bank: bustle, crumbling, undisputed, important

   Key: crumbling

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 38? "All was now _____ and hubbub in the late quiet school room."

   A. apparition

   B. bustle

   C. important

   D. weathercock

   Key: B (bustle)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 16: "Indeed it _____ him to keep on good terms with his pupils." Word bank: discontented, behooved, bustle, Greensburgh

   Key: behooved

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 26? "Ichabod Crane had a soft and foolish heart toward the sex; and it is not to be wondered at that so tempting a morsel soon found favor in his eyes; more _____ after he had visited her in her paternal mansion."

   A. especially

   B. important

   C. weathercock

   D. dilated

   Key: A (especially)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 45? "Old farmers, a spare _____ race, in homespun coats and breeches, blue stockings, huge shoes and magnificent pewter buckles."

   A. shrewdness

   B. especially

   C. completely

   D. leathernfaced

   Key: D (leathernfaced)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 9: "The dominant spirit, however, that haunts this enchanted region, and seems to be commander-in-chief of all the powers of the air, is the _____ of a figure on horseback without a head." Word bank: apparition, undisputed, crumbling, behooved

   Key: apparition

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · RL.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 35: "He that wins a thousand common hearts, is therefore entitled to some renown; but he who keeps _____ sway over the heart of a coquette, is indeed a hero." Word bank: undisputed, shrewdness, discontented, appearance

    Key: undisputed

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow"?

    A. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

    B. Superstition used against a credulous man

    C. A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

    D. Harlem as promised refuge and trap

    Key: B (Superstition used against a credulous man)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 67 reveal about the character or situation? “His heart began to sink within him; he endeavored to resume his psalm tune, but his parched tongue clove to the roof of his mouth, and he could not utter a stave.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 67) accurately and quotes “endeavored” and “parched”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.5] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “The school-house stood in a rather lonely but pleasant situation, just at the foot of a woody hill, with a brook running close by, and a…”

    B. “Though many years have elapsed since I trod the drowsy shades of Sleepy Hollow, yet I question whether I should not still find the same…”

    C. “The dominant spirit, however, that haunts this enchanted region, and seems to be commander-in-chief of all the powers of the air, is the…”

    D. “His head was small, and flat at top, with huge ears, large green glassy eyes, and a long snipe nose, so that it looked like a weathercock,…”

    Key: C (“The dominant spirit, however, that haunts this enchanted region, and seems to be commander-in-chief of all the powers of the air, is the…”)

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 37 reveal about the character or situation? “In this way matters went on for some time, without producing any material effect on the relative situation of the contending powers.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 37) accurately and quotes “contending” and “producing”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 71 shapes its tone: “An inquiry was set on foot, and after diligent investigation they came upon his traces.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 71) accurately and quotes “investigation” and “diligent”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 68 shapes its tone: “This road leads through a sandy hollow shaded by trees for about a quarter of a mile, where it crosses the bridge famous in goblin story, and just beyond swells the green knoll on which stands the whitewashed church.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 68) accurately and quotes “whitewashed” and “quarter”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “He assisted the farmers occasionally in the lighter labors of their farms; helped to make hay; mended the fences; took the horses to water; drove the cows from pasture; and cut wood for the winter fire.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 17) accurately and quotes “occasionally” and “assisted”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to greed and courtship and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The legend. The words “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) are the evidence: their wording makes this point in the text itself.

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 61 reveal about the character or situation? “It was the very witching time of night that Ichabod, heavy-hearted and crest-fallen, pursued his travel homewards, along the sides of the lofty hills which rise above Tarry Town, and which he had traversed so cheerily in the afternoon.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 61) accurately and quotes “afternoon” and “traversed”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “Some say that the place was bewitched by a high German doctor during the early days of the settlement; others, that an old Indian chief, the prophet or wizard of his tribe, held his powwows there before the country was discovered by Master…” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 8) accurately and quotes “discovered” and “settlement”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 65 shapes its tone: “It stirred not, but seemed gathered up in the gloom, like some gigantic monster ready to spring upon the traveller.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 65) accurately and quotes “traveller” and “gathered”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 47 shapes its tone: “Fain would I pause to dwell upon the world of charms that burst upon the enraptured gaze of my hero, as he entered the state parlor of Van Tassel's mansion.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 47) accurately and quotes “enraptured” and “Tassel's”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 73 to the story's treatment of rural community: “The mysterious event caused much speculation at the Church on the following Sunday.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 73) accurately and quotes “speculation” and “mysterious”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to rural

community and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 19 reveal about the character or situation? “Our man of letters, therefore, was peculiarly happy in the smiles of all the country damsels.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 19) accurately and quotes “peculiarly” and “therefore”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It then states the inference in one sentence and backs it with that detail.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “The British and American line had run near it during the war; it had therefore been the scene of marauding, and infested with refugees, cow boys, and all kinds of border chivalry.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 53) accurately and quotes “marauding” and “therefore”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 48 to the story's treatment of rural community: “He was a kind and thankful toad, whose heart dilated in proportion as his skin was filled with good cheer; and whose spirits rose with eating, as some men's do with drink.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 48) accurately and quotes “proportion” and “thankful”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to rural community and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 63 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “As Ichabod approached this fearful tree, he began to whistle: he thought his whistle was answered: it was but a blast sweeping sharply through the dry branches.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 63) accurately and quotes “approached” and “branches”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to greed and courtship and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 39 shapes its tone: “The animal he bestrode was a broken-down plough horse, that had outlived almost everything but his viciousness.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 39) accurately and quotes “viciousness” and “everything”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 57 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “Such was one of the favorite haunts of the headless horseman, and the place where he was most frequently encountered.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 57) accurately and quotes “encountered” and “frequently”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to greed and

courtship and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 29 shapes its tone: “It was one of those spacious farm-houses, with high-ridged, but lowly-sloping roofs, built in the style handed down from the first Dutch settlers.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 29) accurately and quotes “settlers” and “spacious”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It explains the tone those words create (for example, whether they make the moment tense, ironic or tender) and why the author chose them. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of rural community: “Though many years have elapsed since I trod the drowsy shades of Sleepy Hollow, yet I question whether I should not still find the same trees and the same families vegetating in its sheltered bosom.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 12) accurately and quotes “vegetating” and “sheltered”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to rural community and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 55 to the story's treatment of rural community: “This is perhaps the reason why we so seldom hear of ghosts except in our long-established Dutch communities.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 55) accurately and quotes “communities” and “established”, saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to rural community and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.11-12.4] In the line “"Ergo, for a country schoolmaster to be refused the hand of a Dutch heiress, is a certain step to high preferment in the state."”, what does “preferment” most nearly mean?
A. without purpose
B. promotion to a better position, especially in the church
C. easy to manage or control
D. take in, also metaphorically
Key: B (promotion to a better position, especially in the church)

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.11-12.4] In the line “A sloop was loitering in the distance, dropping slowly down with the tide, her sail hanging uselessly against the mast; and as the reflection of the sky gleamed along the still water, it seemed as if the vessel was…”, what does “uselessly” most nearly mean?
A. promotion to a better position, especially in the church
B. easy to manage or control
C. take in, also metaphorically
D. without purpose
Key: D (without purpose)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “He was satisfied with his wealth, but not proud of it; and piqued himself upon the hearty abundance, rather than the style in which he lived.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: A model answer paraphrases the passage (paragraph 26) accurately and quotes “abundance” and “satisfied”,

saying what those words show about the speaker or situation at that moment. It links the passage to greed and courtship and to one other named moment in the story. The unit's reading of greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · L.11-12.4] In the line “It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.”, what does “imbibed” most nearly mean?

    A. without purpose

    B. easy to manage or control

    C. promotion to a better position, especially in the church

    D. take in, also metaphorically

    Key: D (take in, also metaphorically)

| Rigor version | Items (in order) | Mix |
|---|---|---|
| Scaffolded support | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 13, 15, 16, 17 | recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1 |
| HS Freshman | 9, 5, 7, 2, 10, 1, 3, 6, 8, 4, 14, 18, 19, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23 | recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1 |
| HS Sophomore | 9, 6, 1, 7, 3, 4, 2, 19, 24, 18, 13, 14, 11, 25, 20, 21, 26, 27 | recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2 |
| HS Junior | 6, 3, 1, 2, 4, 8, 19, 13, 11, 14, 18, 24, 21, 28, 15, 20, 26, 29 | recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2 |
| HS Senior | 6, 9, 4, 7, 10, 11, 13, 12, 14, 18, 13, 21, 20, 16, 30, 17, 31, 26 | recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3 |
| AP | 5, 8, 6, 12, 19, 13, 13, 20, 22, 30, 16, 28, 21, 23, 17, 31, 32, 27 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5 |
| College Freshman | 33, 34, 9, 13, 24, 11, 12, 20, 15, 25, 22, 30, 21, 32, 31, 17, 27, 35 | recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5 |
| College Sophomore | 10, 36, 13, 13, 18, 12, 25, 28, 22, 30, 20, 16, 29, 31, 23, 35, 27, 17 | recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6 |
| College Junior | 10, 33, 12, 19, 25, 16, 28, 20, 30, 21, 35, 31, 29, 26, 32, 23, 27, 17 | recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8 |
| College Senior | 9, 33, 18, 13, 21, 22, 16, 15, 25, 30, 35, 32, 29, 26, 17, 23, 31, 27 | recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8 |
| Graduate / PhD | 5, 9, 13, 21, 20, 30, 22, 25, 28, 16, 17, 31, 27, 29, 35, 26, 23, 32 | recall 2, inference 1, analysis 7, synthesis 8 |

# Final paper

**The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: final paper (formal literary analysis)**. Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to greed and courtship.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Legend of Sleepy Hollow finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of rural community. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

**Length:** Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

**Evidence requirement:** at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

| Criterion | Points | Descriptor |
|---|---|---|
| Thesis | 20 | A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper. |
| Evidence | 25 | Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement. |
| Analysis | 30 | Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary. |
| Organization | 15 | Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument. |
| Style and conventions | 10 | Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format. |

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Superstition and imagination

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about superstition and imagination. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of superstition and imagination. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of superstition and imagination, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of superstition and imagination in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Greed and courtship

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about greed and courtship. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops greed and courtship across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of greed and courtship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of greed and courtship, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of greed and courtship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period

and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Rural community

**Scaffolded support** (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about rural community. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops rural community across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of rural community. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of rural community, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of rural community in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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